

2026 · WINNIE NGUYEN

Solution Validation & *User Testing*

Your prototype is a hypothesis. Testing is how you find out if it's right.



• SESSION 7 • 90 MIN

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Former Sr Product Designer at Go1

Former Product Design Instructor at StayLab

— WHAT WE'RE COVERING TODAY

Five phases. One loop closed.

1 Validation mindset *What are you actually testing for?*

2 Choose your method *Right tool for the right question*

3 Write your test plan *Goals, tasks, scenarios, criteria*

4 Run the session *Facilitation and think-aloud*

5 Synthesise & prioritise *From observations to decisions*

Validation Mindset

— BEFORE WE TEST

A prototype is not a deliverable. *It's a hypothesis.*

OPINION

"What do you think?"

Showing people your prototype and asking for reactions produces opinions — useful for ideas, not for decisions.

≠

EVIDENCE

"We believe *[this design]* will help *[this user]* do *[this task]* — we'll know we're right when *[this signal]*."

Testing starts with a question and lets evidence answer it.

— THREE QUESTIONS

Different questions **need different tests.**



Usability

Can users complete the task? Where do they get stuck?

→ MODERATED TASK-BASED TEST



Desirability

Do users want what this offers? Does it feel right?

→ CONCEPT TEST OR POST-TASK DEBRIEF



Comprehension

Do users understand what this is and what to do?

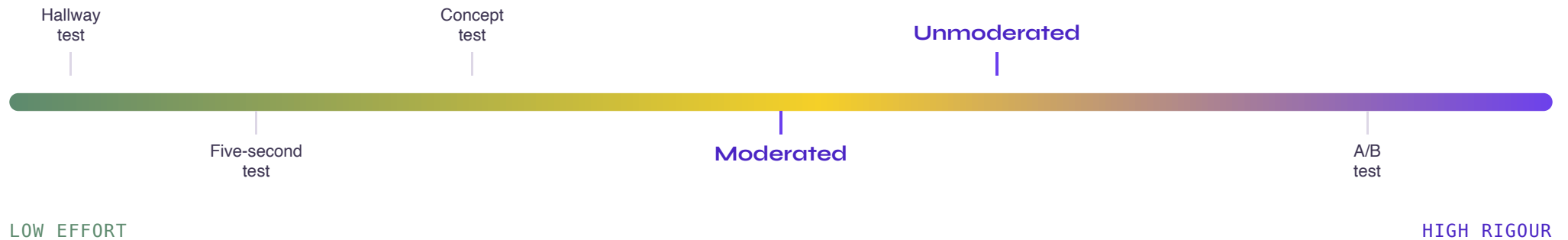
→ FIVE-SECOND TEST OR THINK-ALoud ON L0-FI

Choose
Your Method

An abstract graphic in the bottom right corner consisting of several overlapping, rounded, organic shapes in various shades of purple, creating a layered, wave-like effect.

— THE SPECTRUM

Right method for the right question.



Moderated usability test

MOST RELEVANT NOW

Can users complete tasks? Where do they struggle?

Medium effort 

Unmoderated test (Maze, Lyssna)

MOST RELEVANT NOW

Task completion + drop-off, at scale

Low-medium 

Moderated testing.

ANSWERS

the
WHY

Best for **understanding the why** behind what users do — behaviour, hesitation, and motivation.

1 WHAT IT IS

A live session where you watch one user attempt tasks and ask follow-up questions in the moment.

2 WHY CHOOSE IT

To understand **behaviour and motivation** — why users hesitate, and where their reasoning breaks down.

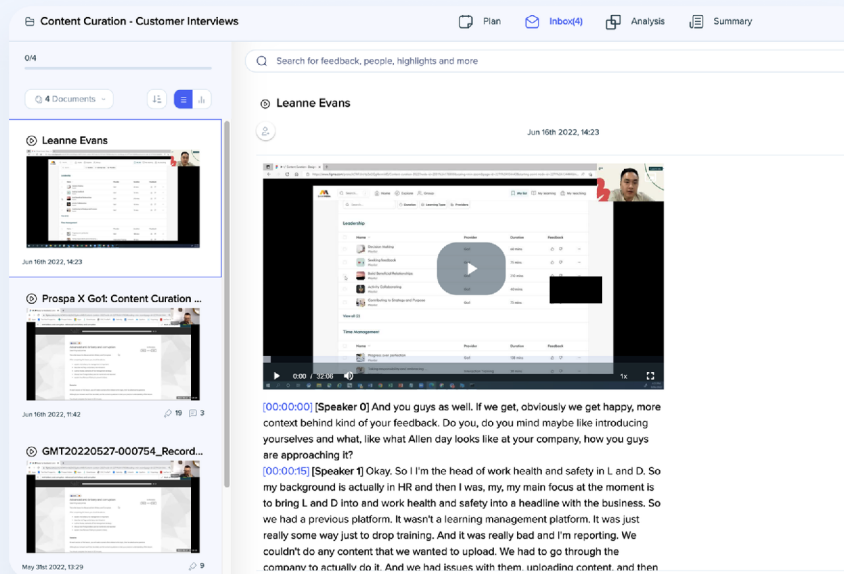
3 HOW TO RUN IT

Schedule 1:1 sessions, give tasks as scenarios, use think-aloud, and probe with neutral prompts. Around 5 users.

— MODERATED · IN ACTION

A live session, captured.

DOVETAIL



Content curation @ Go!

A moderated interview from Go1 — the recording is synced to an auto-timestamped transcript, so every observation stays anchored to what actually happened.

Unmoderated testing.

ANSWERS

the
WHAT

Best for **measuring the what** across many users, fast
— completion, drop-off, click patterns.

1 WHAT IT IS

A self-serve test users complete on their own time, while the tool records every action they take.

2 WHY CHOOSE IT

To measure the **what, at scale** — completion rates, drop-off, and click patterns across many users.

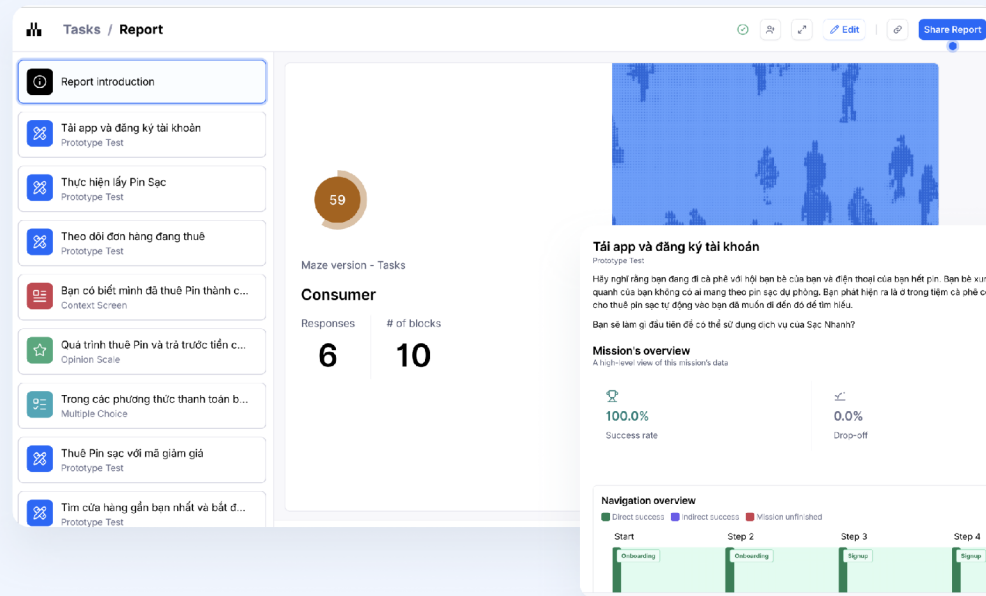
3 HOW TO RUN IT

Publish a link (Maze, Lyssna), send it to a customer segment, and read the aggregate report. Larger samples.

— UNMODERATED · IN ACTION

Results, at scale.

MAZE



Pinbus App

A Maze test report — task completion rate, success rate, and the step-by-step navigation overview show exactly where users dropped off.

— MAKE THE CALL

Do you need the *why*, or just the *what*?

Moderated → **the WHY**

Unmoderated → **the WHAT**

The 5-user rule applies to moderated qualitative testing only — unmoderated and A/B tests need larger samples to be valid.

ACTIVITY

5 minutes

Look at your prototype. What's the one thing you most want to know? Pick moderated or unmoderated — and write one sentence justifying the choice. Share back.

Write Your Test Plan

Five components. One page.

1

Goal *What question does this test answer? One sentence, linked to the hypothesis.*

2

Participant profile *Who are you testing with? The characteristics that matter for this prototype.*

3

Tasks *Specific actions participants attempt — realistic and neutral, no hints.*

4

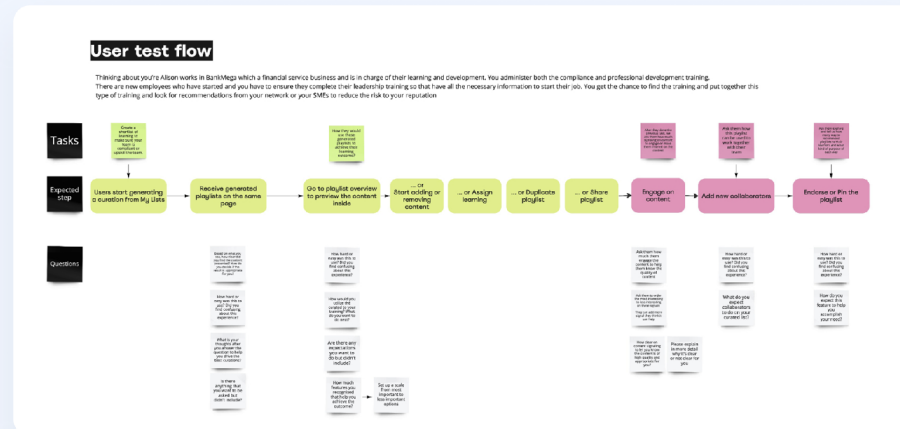
Scenarios *Context that sets up the task without giving away the answer.*

5

Success criteria *How you'll know the task was completed — defined before the session.*

One page, ready to run.

G01



Content curation @ Go1

A research plan document from the Go1 Content Curation project — goal, participants, tasks, scenarios, and success criteria, all on one page.

— WRITE IT RIGHT

Neutral language. **No hints.**



BAD TASKS

"Click the Buy Now button to purchase the item."

Gives away where to click.

"Would you use this checkout flow?"

Asks for opinion, not behaviour.

"Imagine you want to buy something. What would you do?"

Too vague — no context.



GOOD TASKS

"You've decided to buy a gift for a friend. Show me how you'd complete the purchase."

Realistic context, neutral, clear goal.

"You need to update your billing address before your next payment. How would you do that?"

Specific situation, no hints.

"You've just joined a new team. Set up your profile so teammates can find you."

A role and a reason to act.

Generate a test script in under 5 minutes.

- PASTE INTO YOUR AI TOOL

"I'm testing a prototype of [product]. The main user flow is: [describe]. Write a test plan with: 1 goal, 1 participant profile, 3 realistic task scenarios with success criteria. Use neutral language – no hints about where to click."

THEN THINK CRITICALLY

- ☐ Are the tasks neutral, or do they give away the answer?
- ☐ Did AI understand who the real user is?
- ☐ Are the success criteria measurable?
- ☐ What context did AI not have?

ACTIVITY

10 minutes

Generate a draft test plan with AI. Then edit: cut any leading language, fix the success criteria, adjust the participant profile to match your real user. You leave with a test plan you can use this week.

Run the Session

— YOUR JOB

Watch.
Listen.
Don't help.

NEUTRAL PROMPTS

"What are you thinking right now?"

"What would you do next if I weren't here?"

"What were you expecting to happen?"

— HOW TO RUN IT

Six principles.

- 01 Ask before you show**
Context questions first — build rapport and a baseline.
 - 02 Test on the right people**
Not colleagues. Real potential users — and extreme users.
 - 03 Ask, don't tell**
Turn questions back: "What would you do if I wasn't here?"
 - 04 Stay neutral**
Don't sell the design. Let the prototype speak.
 - 05 Adapt when needed**
Rephrase a confusing prompt. Rigid scripts that yield no data are worse.
 - 06 Let users contribute**
"I wish this did X" — ask them to describe it. It reveals the need.
-

Synthesise & Prioritise

— CAPTURE FIRST

Separate observations from interpretations.

✓ Likes

What worked. What users responded positively to.

✗ Criticisms

Where users got stuck, confused, or frustrated.

? Questions

Questions the session raised — from users or the team.

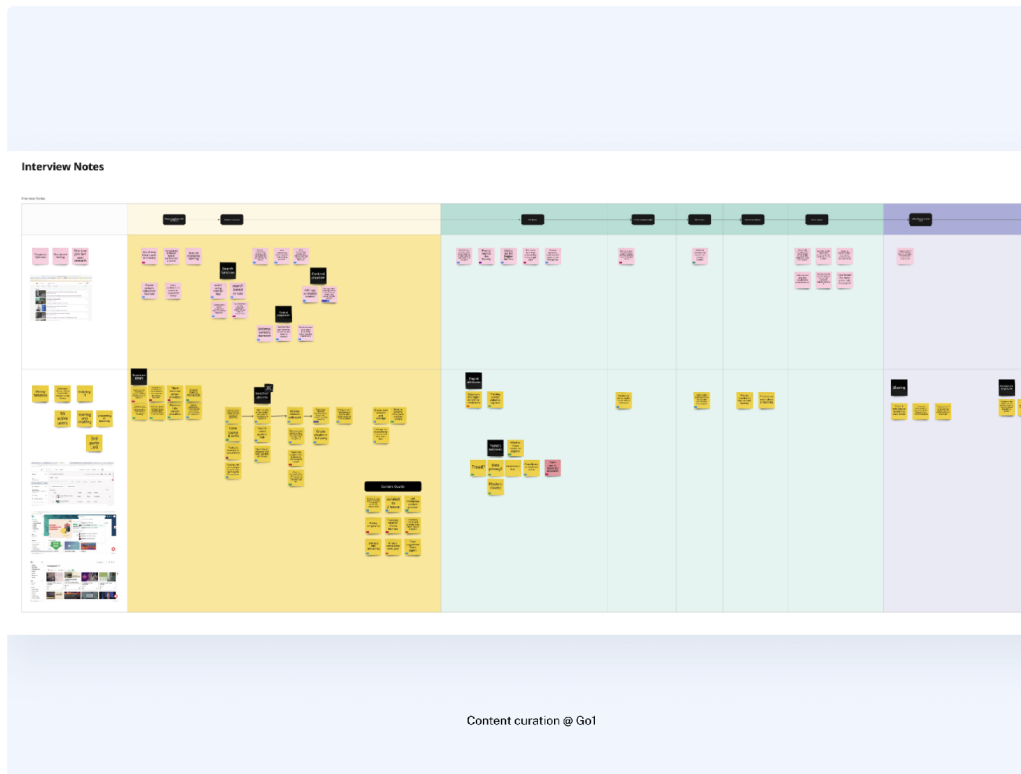
✦ Ideas

Ideas the session sparked — suggestions and insights.

The rule: In Criticisms, write what the user **did** — not what you think it means. "User spent 40 seconds on the payment screen without clicking" is an observation. "The payment screen is confusing" is an interpretation. Keep them separate.

— BEFORE SYNTHESIS · RAW CAPTURE

Raw notes, **before** themes.



Raw interview notes from Go1 — sticky notes organised by participant across the board. Capture first, interpret later.

— TRANSLATE

What users did → what it means.

"[User] did [X]" → "Users struggle to [Y] because [Z]"

OBSERVATION

"3 of 5 participants tried to tap the logo to go home."



FINDING

"Users expect the logo to be a home button — the current navigation has no clear home action."

— THE FINISHED FORMAT · WHY IT MATTERS

Make the evidence official.



It earns credibility

Backed by quotes, not just stickies.



It travels

Anyone can read it, long after the session.



It drives decisions

Each finding points to a fix.

FROM USER INTERVIEW

WHAT "SIGNALS" ARE NEEDED ON THE RESULT IN TOP-LEVEL

SEARCH RESULTS?

- We showed a static design for search result with including content signal.
- 2 persons feedback on this design

Key insights:

- 2 persons curious on why it popular to show at the top of search results
- 1 need to see high learning spot appears in search towards the top without open up the piece of content to preview
- 1 person want to see top learners, top contributors, most searched popular channels
- 1 person wants to see 'Most viewed' content
- 1 person like to see how people's interaction with content to see how people give feedback on it
 - Seeing examples in comments and ratings becomes quite helpful
- Want to use something like recommended by the company
- Want to a video of our CEO doing XYZ

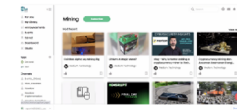
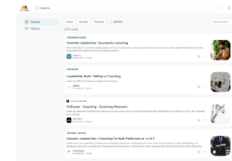
"You can see like your top learners, top contributors, most searched popular channels"

- Research participant

"here's a video of our CEO doing XYZ and here's a , unconscious bias video or something like that that kinda have to go through. So you kind of like break it up a little bit and make it relevant to the role that they're doing or what they're supposed to be learning."

So I think that's where we would utilize that."

- Research participant

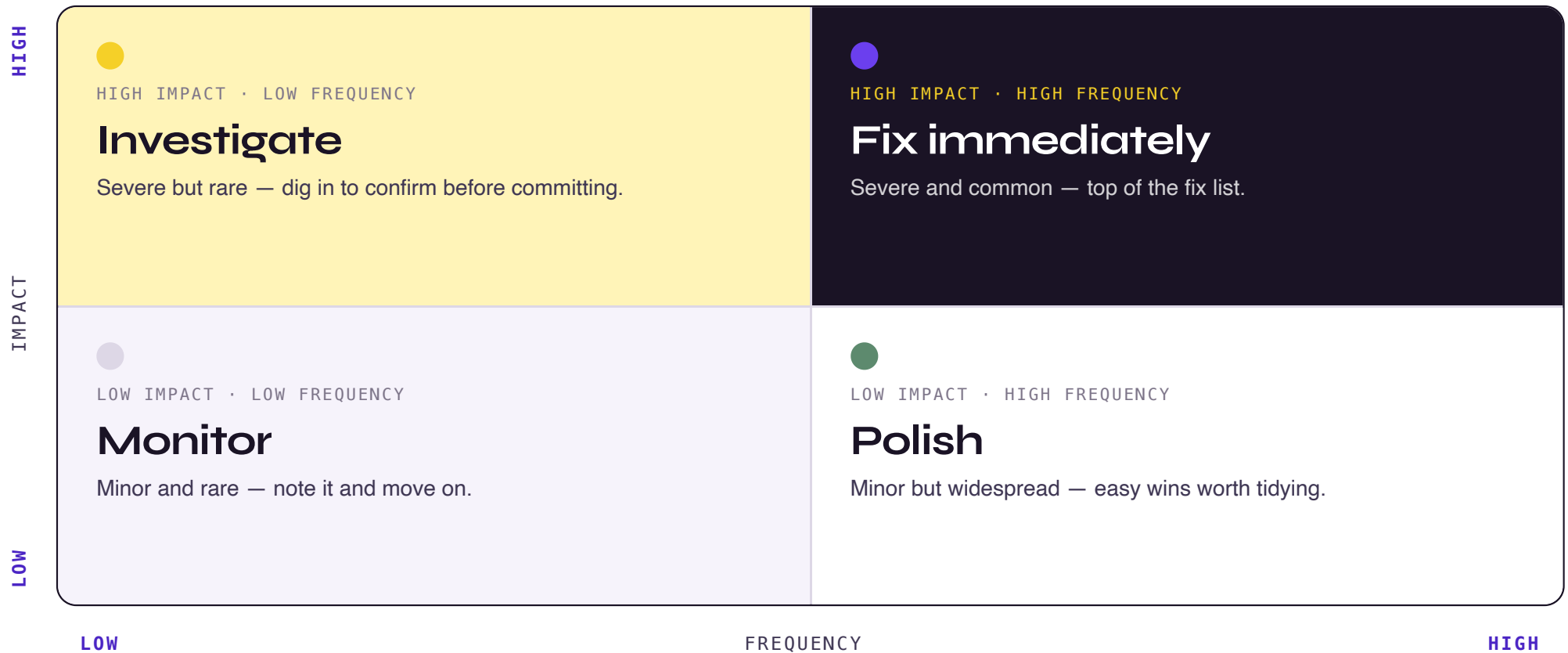


Content curation @ Go1

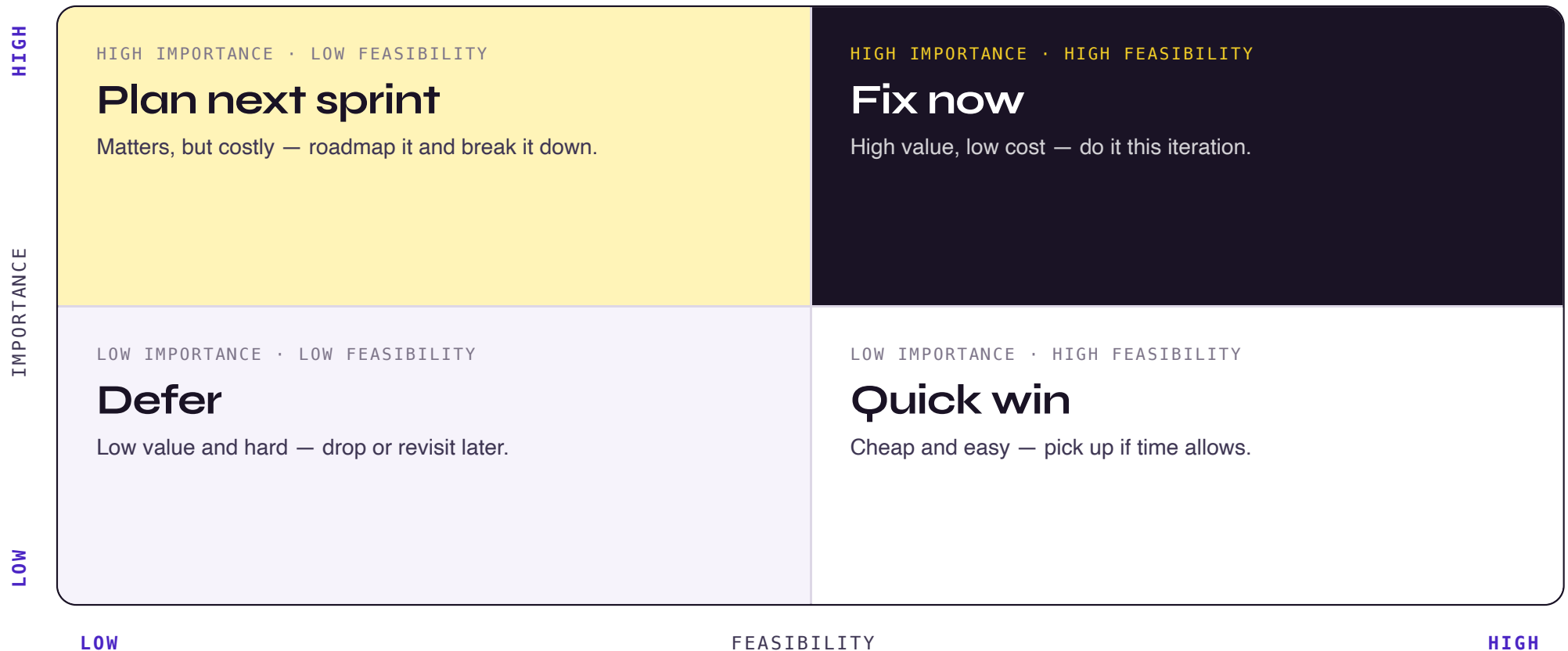
A research report from Go1 — observations translated into structured findings, backed by participant quotes and screenshots.

— PRIORITISE

Not all issues are equal.

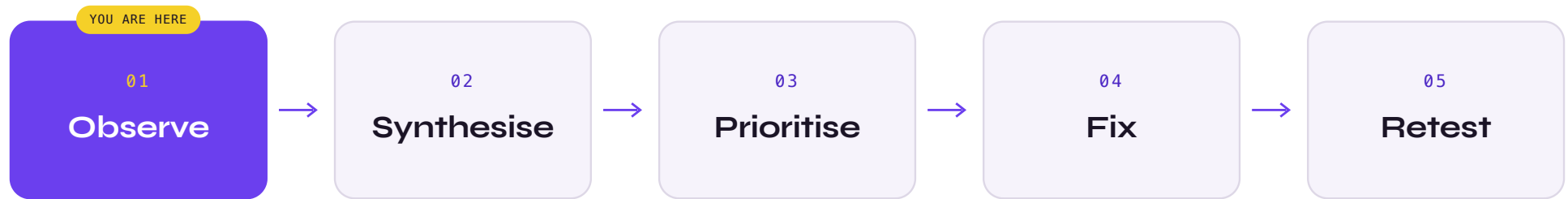


Fix now or plan for later?



— THE CYCLE

Testing doesn't end. **It iterates.**



← REPEAT · 2–3 ROUNDS SURFACE MOST CRITICAL ISSUES →

Run a Moderated Usability Test

BEFORE

- Share the prototype link or set up the device in advance.
- Brief: "I'm testing the design, not you. Say what you're thinking."
- Have your test plan and Feedback Capture Grid ready.



DURING

- Give each task as a scenario — then let them go. Don't help.
- Take notes in the Criticisms and Questions quadrants as you go.
- Use "What are you thinking right now?" when they go quiet.



AFTER

- Complete all four quadrants of the grid.
- Write 3–5 findings in observation → finding format.
- Prioritise with impact x frequency; pick the one biggest change.

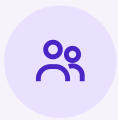


DELIVERABLE

A **Feedback Capture Grid**, **3–5 findings**, and **one priority recommendation**.
Bring it to Session 8.

Go again — different method

CHOOSE ONE — WHICHEVER YOU DIDN'T USE FOR ASSIGNMENT A



Moderated

Recruit a second participant. Compare their session to the first — what changed, what held?



Unmoderated

Pick any tool — Maze, Lyssna, recorded Zoom, a written survey — and share your test link with what you want to learn.

ONE THING TO CARRY FORWARD

*"Testing is not a final step. It's how design **earns its decisions.**"*

The prototype you built is the beginning of the evidence, not the end of the work. Every finding from a test session brings you closer to something that actually works for real people.

— *Winnie Nguyen*